AFTERCARE

# After Deep Tissue Massage

Deep work asks a lot of your muscles, so some soreness is normal. These habits help you recover comfortably.

YOUR LOGO

| WHEN | WHAT'S NORMAL | DO | AVOID |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Today**<br>right after | Feeling tired, a little lightheaded or tender in the areas we worked. | Sit up slowly. Drink water if you're thirsty. Ice or heat, whichever feels better. | Heavy training or long runs for [24] hours. Alcohol and hot tubs tonight. |
| **24–72 hours**<br>recovery | Soreness like after a hard workout, maybe light bruising, easing daily. | Gentle stretching, walking, a warm bath, or ice for 10 to 15 minutes on sore spots. | Pressing on or rolling bruised spots. Training hard through sharp or worsening pain. |
| **The week**<br>back to it | Freer movement and less tightness, even if some returns with load. | Ease back into training. Keep up stretching, sleep and any exercises I suggested. | Jumping straight to your heaviest sessions, or ignoring worsening pain. |
| **Next visit**<br>in [2–4] weeks | Each session tends to feel less sore as your tissue adapts to the work. | Tell me how long soreness lasted, any bruising, and any new injury or medication. | Booking on the day of a race, a new injury, or right after a hard training block. |

## GOOD TO KNOW

- Soreness for 1 to 3 days is common after deep work
- Ice calms hot, sore spots; heat eases stiffness
- Muscle soreness should ease a little each day
- Sleep and gentle movement speed recovery
- Light bruising can happen, more so on blood thinners
- Water is for comfort; drink what feels right to you
- Tell me what pressure felt right for next time
- Plan big events [2–3] days after deep work

### Ease off
No heavy training for [24] hours.

### Ice or heat
Whatever feels best on sore spots.

### Stretch gently
Short, easy stretches, no bouncing.

### Rest well
Sleep is when you recover.

## CALL YOUR DOCTOR IF YOU NOTICE

- One calf swollen, red, warm or painful
- Numbness or tingling that doesn't fade
- Bruising that spreads or keeps growing
- Sharp pain or soreness past 3 days

**Chest pain or sudden shortness of breath: call 911. Then let me know so I can note it in your record.**

PRESSURE WE USED _____

ICE OR HEAT _____

YOUR NEXT VISIT DATE _____